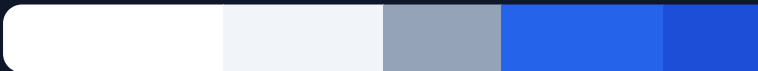




DESIGN PROPOSAL · JULY 2026

UI Redesign Plan

A complete visual and experience refresh — moving from the 2025 black & yellow industrial theme to a calm, professional blue / white / gray / black system.



THE PROPOSED PALETTE — WHITE · GRAY · BLUE · INK · BLACK

Why redesign, and why now

The current interface — an "industrial monument" theme built around **pure black, utility yellow and zinc gray** — has served since 2025. It is bold, but it now works against the product: yellow is doing double duty as brand accent *and* data colour, near-everything is shouted in uppercase, and three visual dialects coexist across pages. Meanwhile the application has grown from a single dashboard into a suite (FIS/FRE analysis, Fuel Report, Registry, ingestion) that needs a calmer, more scalable visual system.

Objectives

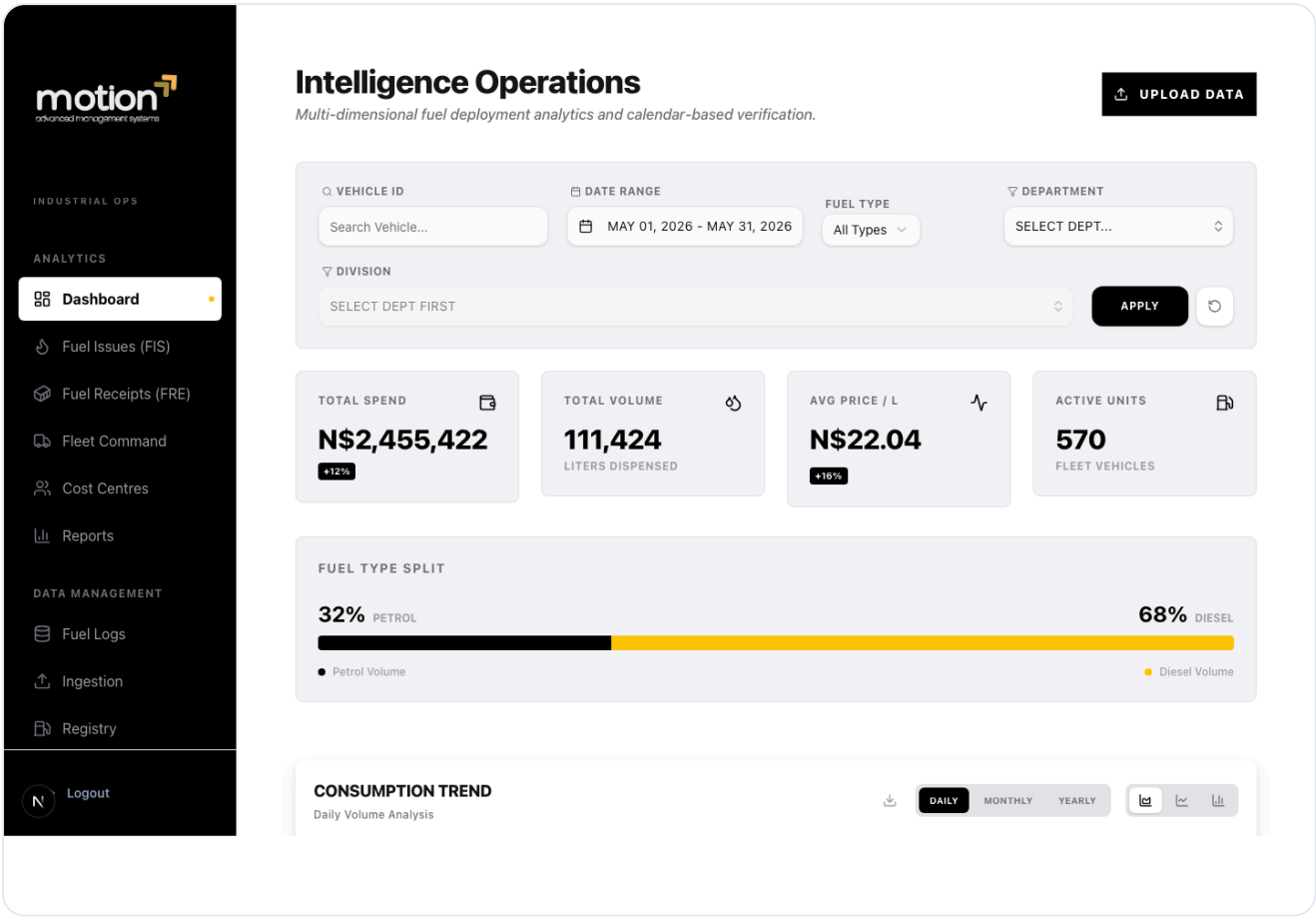
- **Trustworthy, municipal-grade appearance** — a blue/white/gray/black palette reads as financial-institutional, fitting a fuel budget tool used across municipal departments.
- **Colour that carries meaning** — blue for interaction and primary data, gray for structure, black/ink for content; semantic green/red reserved exclusively for good/bad signals.
- **One design language on every page** — dashboard, reports, settings and auth currently differ in radius, accent and tone; the redesign unifies them under one token set.
- **Accessibility to WCAG AA** — the current yellow-on-white elements fail contrast at 1.3:1; every proposed pairing meets or exceeds 4.5:1 for text.
- **Zero functional risk** — this is a re-skin plus targeted UX fixes. Layout structure, Recharts, shadcn/ui and all data logic remain; the work is concentrated in design tokens and component styling.

What this document contains

SECTION	CONTENTS
02 · Current-state audit	Annotated screenshots of the live application with numbered findings and severity.
03 · Colour system	The full proposed palette with hex values, usage rules, 60/30/10 distribution and WCAG contrast proof.
04 · Type & spacing	Typography scale, casing rules and spacing/radius tokens.
05 · Component redesigns	Before/after treatments: sidebar, KPI cards, charts, filters, tables, buttons.
06 · Page mockups	Full dashboard mockup in the new system, FIS/FRE treatment, dark mode preview.
07 · UX improvements	Experience fixes that ride along with the re-skin: navigation, filter presets, states, consistency.
08 · Roadmap	Six implementation phases with effort estimates and a token migration map.

Guiding principle: keep the monumental confidence of the current design — generous spacing, strong numerals, decisive hierarchy — but swap the traffic-sign palette for one that lets the data, not the chrome, be the loudest thing on screen.

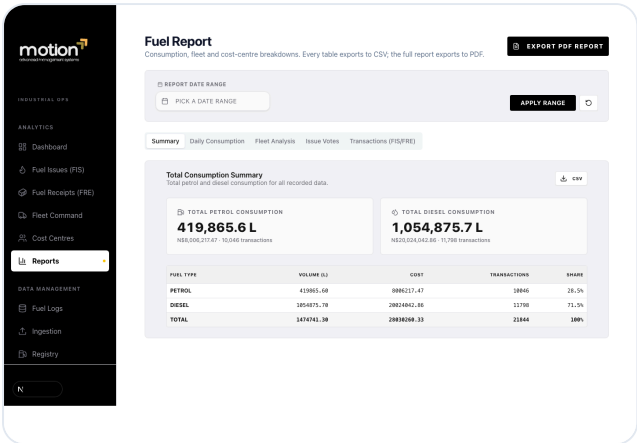
The dashboard today



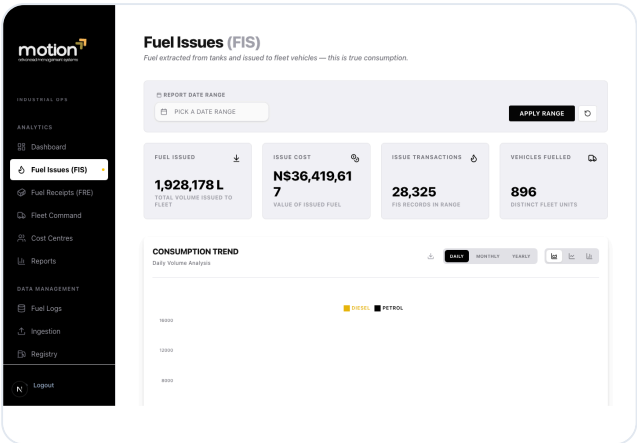
Live capture — Intelligence Operations dashboard, July 2026 (1440px viewport).

#	SEVERITY	FINDING
1	Critical	Yellow as a data colour. The Diesel share of the fuel-split bar and chart series use #FDE047 on white — 1.3:1 contrast (WCAG requires 3:1 for graphics). It also reads as a <i>warning</i> , not a fuel type.
2	Critical	Logo contrast. The gold/gray logo is nearly invisible on white headers (see next page) and dark headers alike; there is no approved reversed variant in use.
3	High	Flat monochrome hierarchy. KPI values, buttons, icons, table text and bars are all near-black. Nothing guides the eye; the +12% trend pill is black even when the trend is bad.
4	High	Uppercase everywhere. Labels, buttons, table headers, nav groups and even body copy are letter-spaced caps at 10–11px, which slows reading and consumes horizontal space in tables.
5	Medium	Filter bar bulk. The always-open five-field filter panel occupies ~20% of the viewport before any data appears; "SELECT DEPT FIRST" exposes an implementation detail as UI.
6	Medium	Pure black sidebar. #000 against #FFF content is the harshest possible transition; active state (white pill) and yellow logo compete.

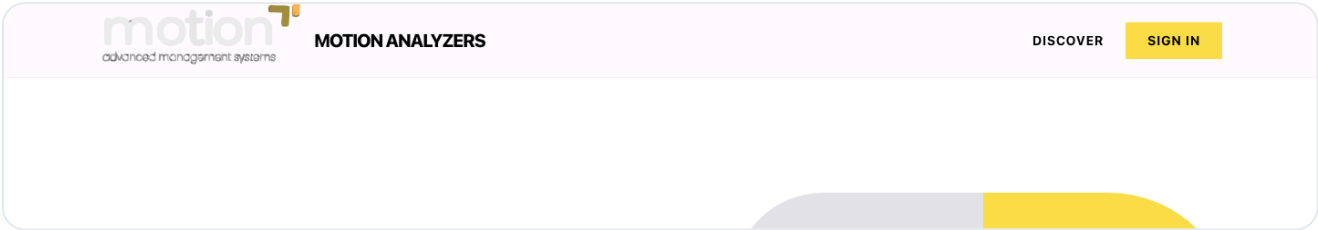
Inconsistency across pages



Fuel Report page — note the **slate**-toned text and different tab styling from the dashboard's zinc/yellow.



Fuel Issues (FIS) page — same components, but yellow accent card borders and black icon chips reappear.



Landing page header — the logo (top-left) almost disappears against the white background; hero content depends entirely on JS animation to become visible.

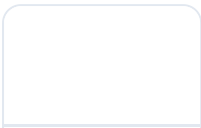
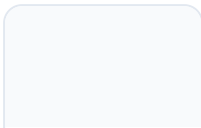
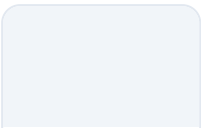
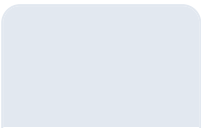
Additional findings

#	SEVERITY	FINDING
7	High	Three visual dialects. Dashboard = sharp corners/zinc/yellow · Reports = slate palette, softer chrome · Settings = 2rem-radius "glass" cards with a brown (#B99A8B) accent found nowhere else. Users perceive three different apps.
8	Medium	Invisible landing content. Hero text mounts at opacity 0 and animates in; with reduced-motion, slow devices or crawlers it simply never appears.
9	Medium	No loading/empty language. Some pages show a spinner, some show nothing, empty tables each invent their own message; no skeletons anywhere.
10	Medium	Trend badges lack semantics. "+12%" and "+16%" render identically whether the change is favourable or costly.
11	Keep	What already works: the monumental spacing, grouped sidebar IA, KPI-first dashboard structure, latest-month default, tabbed Fuel Report, and CSV/PDF exports are all solid — the redesign preserves them.

The new palette

Four families, strictly role-based. Blue is the *only* saturated colour in the interface; it therefore always means "interactive or primary data".

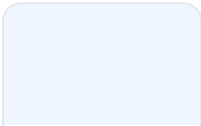
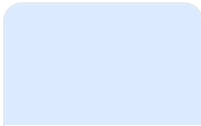
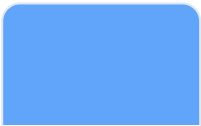
Structure — white & gray (≈60% of every screen)

					
Surface #FFFFFF	Page background #F8FAFC	Panel / hover #F1F5F9	Borders #E2E8F0	Disabled / hints #94A3B8	Muted text #64748B

Ink & black — content (≈30%)

		
Secondary text #334155	Ink — headings, KPIs, sidebar #0F172A	True black — logo & print only #000000

Blue — action & data (≈10%)

					
Tint — selected rows #EFF6FF	Active nav / badges #DBEAFE	Data: Petrol series #60A5FA	Charts primary #3B82F6	Action — buttons, links #2563EB	Data: Diesel / hover #1D4ED8

Semantic accents (used sparingly, never decorative)

		
Positive trend #059669	Warning #D97706	Negative / destructive #DC2626

Contrast proof (WCAG 2.1)

PAIRING	RATIO	VERDICT	USED FOR
Ink #0F172A on White	17.9 : 1	AAA	Headings, KPI numerals, body
White on Ink #0F172A	17.9 : 1	AAA	Sidebar text
White on Blue #2563EB	4.6 : 1	AA	Primary buttons
Blue #1D4ED8 on White	6.3 : 1	AA	Links, active labels, Diesel series
Muted #64748B on White	4.8 : 1	AA	Captions, secondary labels
Current: Yellow #FDE047 on White	1.3 : 1	FAIL	— being retired

Calmer type, same confidence

Typography scale (Geist / Inter retained)

ROLE	SPEC
Page title	28px / 800 / -0.5px — sentence case
Section title	17px / 700 — sentence case
KPI numeral	30px / 800 / tabular-nums, Ink
Body / cells	12px / 400–500, #334155
Micro-label	10px / 600 / +0.6px caps — the only caps left
Buttons	12.5px / 600 — sentence case (no more shouting)

Casing rules

- Uppercase survives **only** in micro-labels (KPI captions, table headers).
- Titles, nav items, buttons, descriptions: sentence case.
- Letter-spacing above 1px is banned outside micro-labels.

Spacing & shape tokens

TOKEN	VALUE
Card radius	12px (was mixed 0 / 6 / 32px)
Control radius	8px inputs · 8px buttons
Card padding	24px (unchanged — monumental)
Grid gap	24px major · 16px minor
Border	1px #E2E8F0 everywhere; shadows only on overlays
Focus ring	2px #2563EB at 40% — visible keyboard focus on every control

One radius, one border, one shadow rule. The single biggest "feels new" win costs nothing: the settings page's 32px glass cards, the dashboard's square corners and the reports page's soft cards all collapse into one 12px-radius bordered card.

Specimen

Fuel intelligence dashboard

Consumption, receipts and cost-centre analytics for the municipal fleet.

TOTAL VOLUME · MAY 2026

111,424 L

Apply filters

Reset

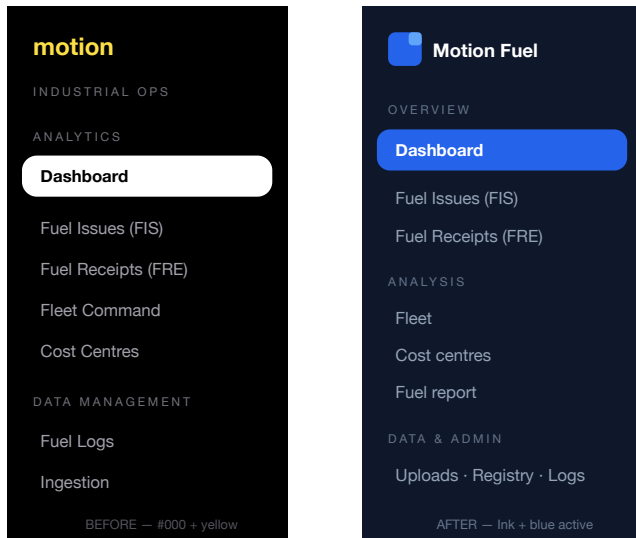
▼ 8%

▲ 12%

Sentence-case titles, ink numerals, blue action button, semantic trend badges (down-is-good for consumption).

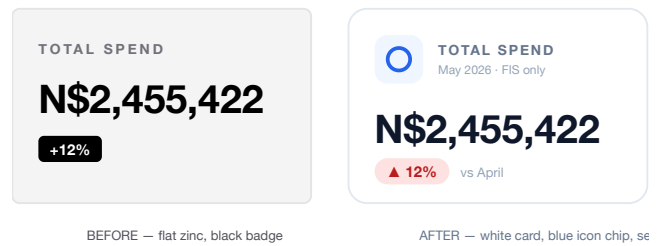
Navigation & KPI cards

Sidebar — before / after



- Ink #0F172A replaces pure black — softer against white content.
- Active item = **blue pill**, unmistakably interactive.
- Three groups (Overview / Analysis / Data & Admin) instead of two, keeping the growing menu scannable.
- White logo variant on dark; blue mark replaces gold.

KPI card — before / after

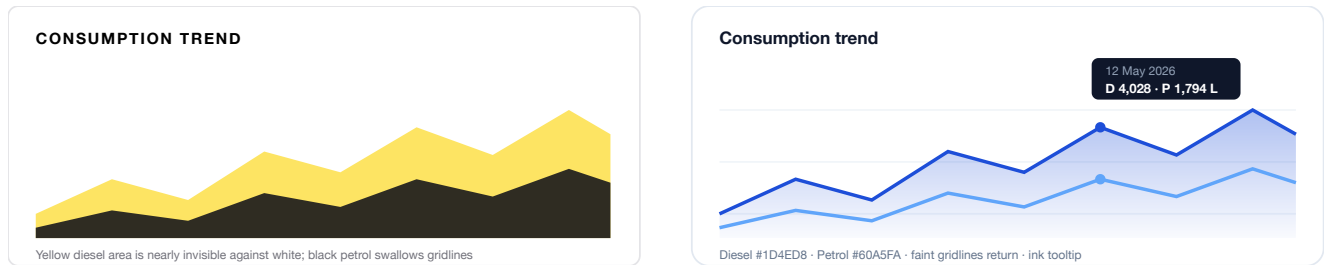


Anatomy changes

- 1 · Icon moves into a blue-tinted chip — brand colour without noise
- 2 · Context line added ("May 2026 · FIS only") — no more guessing scope
- 3 · Trend badge is red when costs rise, green when they fall
- 4 · Comparator label ("vs April") explains the percentage
- 5 · Numeral in Ink, tabular figures — aligned across the KPI row
- 6 · White surface on #F8FAFC page — cards float without shadows

Charts, filters & tables

Chart palette — before / after



- **Diesel = deep blue, Petrol = sky blue** — both AA-compliant on white, colourblind-safe as a light/dark pair, echoed in the fuel-split bar, badges and legends everywhere.
- FRE (receipts) charts use **slate #64748B** so replenishment is never confused with consumption.

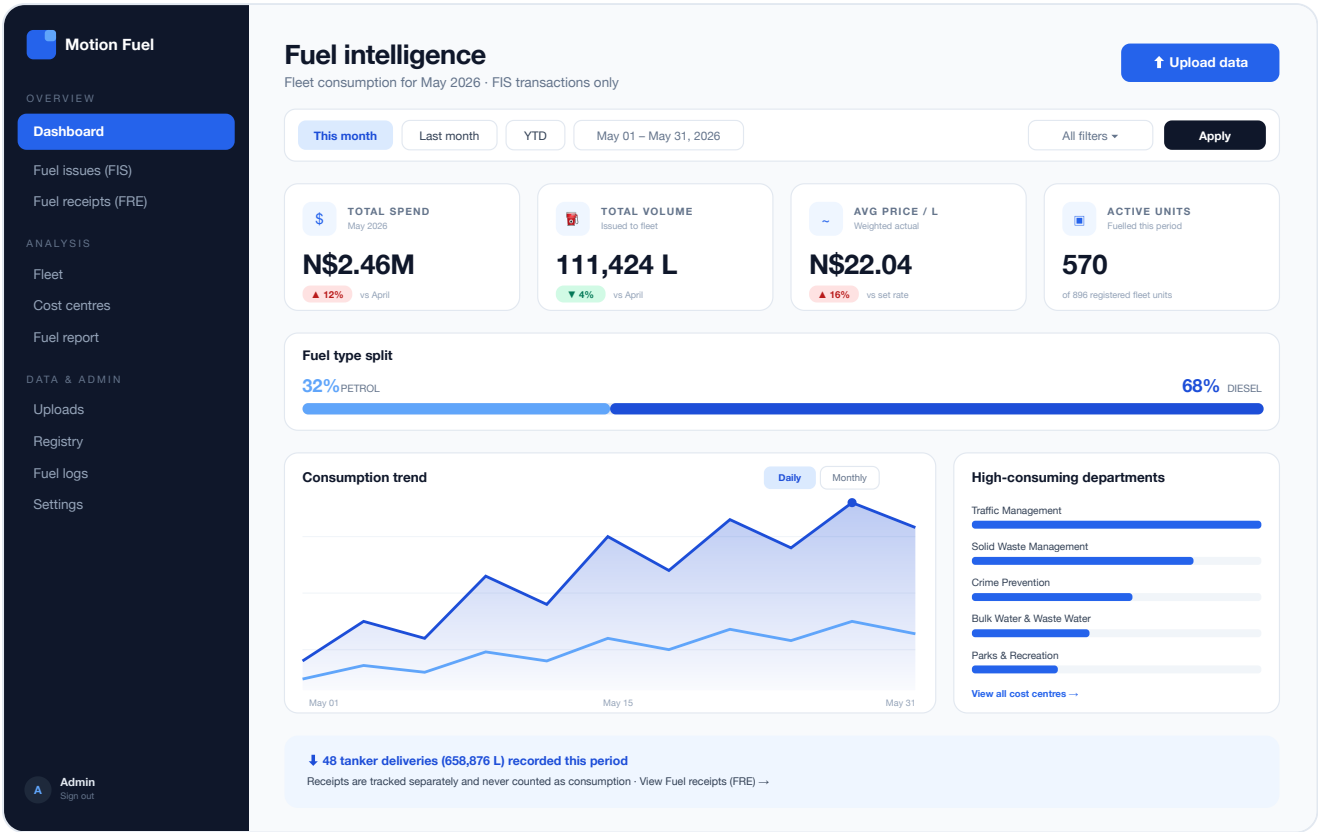
Filter bar — compact with presets

- **One-row bar with date presets** (This month / Last month / YTD) — the most common actions become one click; the five-field grid collapses behind "Department ▼" and appears only when needed.
- Division picker only renders once a department is chosen — no more disabled "SELECT DEPT FIRST" placeholder.

Tables

- Headers: 10px caps in muted gray on **#F8FAFC** (not black-on-dark); rows 12px sentence case; zebra striping with **#F8FAFC**.
- Selected / drill-down rows highlight with **#EFF6FF**; numeric columns right-aligned tabular figures (already partly done — made universal).
- Every data card keeps its CSV button, restyled as a quiet outlined control with the blue download glyph.

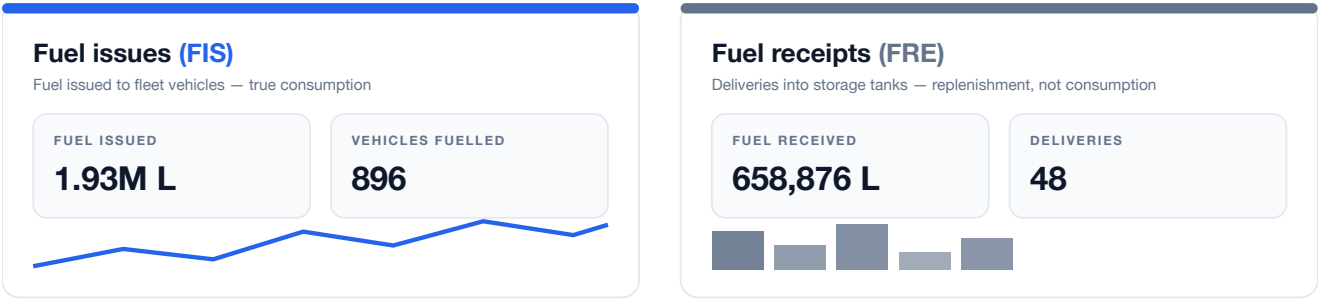
The dashboard, redesigned



Redesigned dashboard: ink sidebar with blue active state, preset date chips, semantic KPI badges, blue data series, and an FRE cross-link banner replacing ambiguity about stock movements.

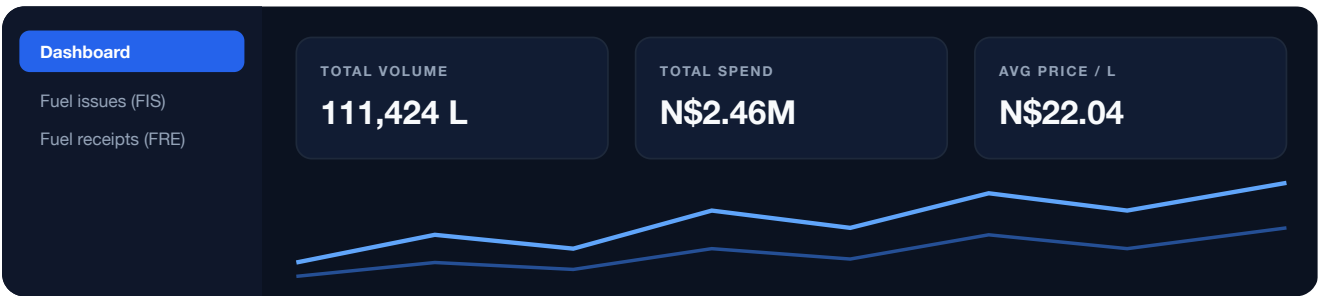
FIS vs FRE identity & dark mode

Twin pages, distinct accents — never confusable



FIS carries the blue "consumption" identity; FRE is deliberately slate-gray with bar (delivery) charts — a colour firewall backing up the data fix already shipped.

Dark mode — ink-based, not gray-based



Dark mode keeps the same blue accents on deep-ink surfaces (#0B1220 / #111C33) — replacing the current dark theme's re-use of yellow.

Experience fixes riding along with the re-skin

AREA	CHANGE	IMPACT
Navigation	Regroup sidebar into Overview / Analysis / Data & Admin; add "Fuel report" to Analysis; user block gets avatar + role, replacing the lone Logout row.	Medium
Date filtering	Preset chips (This month · Last month · YTD · Custom) on Dashboard, FIS, FRE and Reports; the active range is always spelled out next to the page title ("May 2026 · FIS only").	High
Scope clarity	Every KPI card and chart states its scope in a context line; the dashboard shows an FRE banner ("48 deliveries recorded — tracked separately") so totals are never second-guessed again.	High
Loading states	Skeleton cards/tables in gray #F1F5F9 for every async region; no more blank flashes or lone spinners.	Medium
Empty states	One shared empty-state pattern: icon, one-line explanation, primary action (e.g. "No FRE deliveries in this range → Widen range / Upload data").	Medium
Upload flow	Sheet-selection modal gets step indicators (Select file → Choose sheets → Import summary) and shows the duplicate/repair counts on the success screen — the backend already returns them.	Medium
Trend semantics	Consumption/cost increases show red ▲, decreases green ▼ (down-is-good); price-vs-set-rate keeps its own comparator label.	High
Landing & auth	Hero rendered visible by default (animation as enhancement); reversed white-on-ink logo variant; sign-in page adopts the same card system with the blue CTA.	Medium
Accessibility	AA contrast everywhere, 2px blue focus rings, reduced-motion support, min 12px data text, icon buttons get aria-labels.	High
Consistency	Settings, Registry and Reports adopt the same card/radius/accent tokens — one product, one language.	High

Out of scope (unchanged): page structure and routes, Recharts/shadcn component choices, all data logic and APIs, the export pipeline, and authentication. The PDF report template will be recoloured to match (ink header, blue accents) as part of Phase 5.

Six phases, ~2–3 weeks of focused work

- 1 Foundation — design tokens · 1–2 days**
 Rewrite the CSS variables in globals.css (light + dark), map Tailwind theme colours, produce blue/white logo variants. Everything downstream inherits automatically.
- 2 App shell · 2 days**
 Sidebar (ink, blue active pill, three groups, user block), mobile header, page-title pattern with scope line.
- 3 Data visualisation · 2–3 days**
 Recolour all Recharts series (diesel/petrol blues, FRE slate), gridlines, ink tooltips; KPI card anatomy with icon chips, context lines and semantic trend badges; fuel-split bar.
- 4 Filters, tables & forms · 2–3 days**
 Preset-chip filter bar, collapsed advanced filters, unified table styling with selection tint, skeleton + empty states, registry/upload form polish.
- 5 Peripheral surfaces · 2 days**
 Landing page, sign-in, settings page (retire the glass/brown styling), PDF report template recolour.
- 6 Dark mode & QA · 2 days**
 Ink-based dark theme, WCAG audit (automated + manual), cross-page consistency sweep, mobile pass, stakeholder review.

Token migration map (excerpt)

TOKEN	CURRENT	PROPOSED
--primary	#000000	#2563EB
--accent	#FDE047 (yellow)	#DBEAFE (blue tint) — yellow fully retired
--background	#FFFFFF	#F8FAFC (cards stay #FFFFFF)
--card	#F4F4F5 (zinc)	##### with #E2E8F0 border
--foreground	#151515	#0F172A (ink)
--muted-foreground	#71717A (zinc)	#64748B (slate)
Sidebar surface	#000000	#0F172A · active #2563EB
Chart series	#18181B / #FDE047	#1D4ED8 diesel · #60A5FA petrol · #64748B FRE

Success criteria

- 0 WCAG AA contrast failures (currently: every yellow element fails).
- One token file governs 100% of colour — no hard-coded hex in components.
- Every page (incl. Settings and auth) passes a side-by-side consistency check.
- No functional regressions — verified against the existing upload → report flow.

Next step: approve the palette and dashboard mockup (pages 5 & 9), and Phase 1 can begin as a single low-risk pull request touching only design tokens.